

APPENDIX: NEW MAGIC ITEMS

The following new magic items appear in this adventure.

AMULET OF THE STYX

Wondrous item, rare

This amulet of smoked glass on a platinum chain contains a small amount of Styx water, making it resemble a round black gem unless closely inspected. While wearing the amulet, you are immune to the pixelating curse.

In addition, when you sleep or trance, you dream the lost memories of a random creature that has died, giving you some of that creature's skills and insights. At the end of a long rest taken while you wear the *amulet of the Styx*, you gain proficiency in one skill or with one tool of your choice. You cannot already have proficiency with the skill or tool kit. You lose this temporary proficiency at the end of your next long rest.

BOOK OF PATTERNS

Wondrous item, legendary (requires attunement)

This ancient book appears to be a fine spellbook bound in the skin of some extradimensional creature. But the book contains no text, instead being filled with strange patterns. Some are curves; some are cubes; others are spiraling designs, or stars, or leaves and plant life; or patterns like hair and veins and flesh. Many of the patterns contain optical illusions, and seem to move disturbingly when seen from the corner of a viewer's eye.

A creature that merely looks at this book for the first time must succeed on a DC 17 Wisdom saving throw or become charmed by the book. While charmed in this way, the creature is incapacitated and has a speed of 0. Unless it takes damage or is shaken out of its torpor by another creature as an action, the charmed creature remains staring at the book indefinitely, suffering one level of exhaustion every 4 hours until dead. A creature that succeeds on the save or has the charm broken can read the book safely.

Studying the book requires 48 hours of effort over a period of 7 or fewer days. At the end of this study, you must make a DC 17 Charisma saving throw. On a failed save, you gain a form of indefinite madness (see chapter 8 of the *Dungeon Master's Guide*) but can attempt to study the book again. With a successful save, you gain the ability to use charges from the book to cast spells as long as the book is in your possession.

The book has 8 charges. As an action, you can expend 1 or more charges to cast one of the following spells from it (save DC 17): *creation* (5 charges), *hypnotic pattern* (3 charges), *illusory script* (1 charge), *phantasmal force* (2 charges), or *phantasmal killer* (4 charges). The book regains 1d4 + 4 expended charges daily at dawn.

As long as you possess the book, your sleep is filled with dreams of its strange patterns. This might grant

you knowledge of unique rituals or magical effects, as determined by the DM.

CENSER OF BLOOD

Wondrous item, legendary (requires attunement)

This brass incense burner hangs on a brass chain, and is covered with fiendish symbols and the names of ancient vampires. While the censer is on your person, you have advantage on Wisdom (Survival) checks to track by scent and Wisdom (Perception) checks to detect smells. In addition, you are aware of the exact location of any creature within 60 feet of you that is below its hit point maximum.

As an action, you can spill one drop or more of your own blood into the censer, causing it to steam. You suffer one level of exhaustion, and the censer issues forth 1d6 vampiric mists that appear within 10 feet of you. (See *Mordenkainen's Tome of Foes* for information on the vampiric mist.) You can repeat this process to create multiple mists, taking yourself to a maximum of five levels of exhaustion. The vampiric mists don't appear if you are in sunlight.

The summoned vampiric mists understand your language and obey your spoken commands. If you issue no commands, they attack all nearby humanoids except yourself, only sparing those that you specifically command them to.

You reduce levels of exhaustion imposed by the *censer of blood* in the normal fashion. Each mist lasts until it is destroyed, until you die, or until you dismiss it as a bonus action.

HANDKERCHIEF OF DARKNESS

Wondrous item, legendary (requires attunement)

This black velvet handkerchief is inscribed with a repeating pattern of closed eyes. The handkerchief normally appears to be the size of a napkin, but it can be unfolded to the size of a tablecloth.

When the handkerchief is folded to the size of a napkin, you can drop or throw it as an action, creating an area of magical darkness around the handkerchief identical to that created by a *darkness* spell. The darkness endures until the handkerchief is picked up by a creature.

When the handkerchief is unfolded to the size of a tablecloth, you can throw it as an action to have it magically fly high in the air. The handkerchief hovers 50 feet above you and a shadowy fog billows out of it, filling a cylinder 100 feet high and 1,000 feet across, with the handkerchief at its center. The area of the fog is lightly obscured, and creatures that suffer negative effects while in sunlight ignore those effects while within the fog. The fog lasts until the handkerchief is picked up by a creature (typically one that can fly).

MERRENOLOTH'S OAR

Weapon, very rare (requires attunement)

Made of special wood that grows only in the Lower Planes, this long oar is carved with ancient symbols of death from countless cultures.

While you hold the oar, you have advantage on Dexterity checks to maintain your balance while on

a watercraft. In addition, as a bonus action while you hold the oar, you can learn the depth of any water or liquid within sight, and the distance and direction to the closest land while you are on open water.

The *merrenoloth's oar* can be used as a weapon. It is treated as a *+1 lance* when so wielded, and it can be used one-handed while you are on board any watercraft.

PIXEL GLASSES

Wondrous item, very rare (requires attunement)

These unique magic items were created by the derro architect Avnas for use aboard the pixelated Cube 1717. However, their potential benefit to the characters is balanced by a dangerous curse.

The square lenses of the *pixel glasses* are cut of thick, dark glass. While wearing the glasses, you see pixelated objects and creatures as if they were normal, the same way that pixelated creatures do. However, normal creatures and objects look hideously distorted.

Curse. These glasses are cursed, and becoming attuned to them extends the curse to you. While you wear them, you have disadvantage on all saving throws to resist the pixelating curse. If you become cursed while wearing the glasses, the physical symptoms spread from the inside out, though your eyes transform immediately into solid cubes. Creatures at mental level 3 of the curse attempt to hide this from other creatures as long as possible.